

Meeting Summaries of June 18

Date: June 18, 2026

Time: 7pm Vancouver, 8pm Calgary

Attendees: Feng Gu, Prof. Javed, Prof. Jan Ciborowski

Topic: PhD program timing, thesis-completion requirements, and preparation for committee presentation.

Questions, Feedbacks and Suggestions

- Feng asked about whether his PhD start or completion timeline should be deferred while he finishes the master's thesis.
- Prof. Javed explained that Feng may be able to start the PhD in September while completing the thesis by December 31, provided the required documentation and University of Alberta conditions are satisfied.
- Prof. Javed emphasized that Feng should first prepare a strong, comprehensive presentation to convince the committee that the thesis research is in good shape before expecting full review of the written thesis.
- Prof. Jan noted that he prefers to read the thesis directly for detailed feedback, but he would be unavailable the following week because of travel to Newfoundland.
- The advisors recommended contacting Dr. Muhammad Tawheed to clarify official TRU and University of Alberta deadlines, required documents, and thesis-completion procedures.
- The advisors also encouraged Feng to practice the presentation repeatedly and seek feedback from peers before presenting to the committee.

Action Items

- Feng will check official TRU and University of Alberta deadlines for thesis submission, defense, convocation, and PhD-start documentation.
- Feng will email Dr. Muhammad Tawheed to schedule a meeting about required deadlines, forms, and documentation.
- Feng will prepare a thorough thesis-progress presentation for the committee, with emphasis on Chapters 1 and 2 and the current analytical results.
- Feng will arrange a suitable classroom for the in-person presentation and notify Prof. Javed and Prof. Jan of the details.

- Feng will record the presentation with screen and audio, then share the recording with Prof. Jan.
- Feng will practice the presentation with peers, including possible feedback from other CSAT students or Hao.
- Feng will continue thesis writing in parallel and aim to be ready to present the full thesis by July 15, or earlier if possible.
- After the presentation, Feng will follow up with Prof. Javed and Prof. Jan about feedback, thesis-review steps, and possible external examiner selection.
- Prof. Jan will send comments on Feng's thesis progress before leaving for Newfoundland.

Summary of Discussion

- The meeting focused on Feng's PhD program timeline and the requirements for completing the master's thesis while preparing to begin the PhD program.
- Feng asked about deferring or coordinating his PhD start date with the remaining thesis work. The advisors clarified that the critical requirement is to satisfy official documentation and thesis-submission deadlines, especially the December 31 deadline discussed for University of Alberta conditions.
- Prof. Javed stated that he would first review Feng's thesis through a presentation rather than by reading repeated partial drafts. The presentation should demonstrate that the thesis is coherent, complete enough for committee review, and supported by clear results.
- The group discussed preparing a presentation for the following week, especially covering Chapters 1 and 2 and the piecewise quantile-regression work. Feng agreed to prepare slides and improve the clarity of his oral explanation.
- The advisors recommended that Feng confirm all institutional requirements with Dr. Muhammad Tawheed and continue thesis writing while preparing the presentation.